

POLICY ON SUSTAINABLE DONATIONS AND FUNDING

Rationale

This policy establishes the principles and guidelines that the University of Mindanao (UM) will adhere to in its efforts to secure sustainable donations and funding. It aims to ensure that UM's fundraising practices are ethical, transparent, and aligned with its mission, vision, and values, while fostering long-term, mutually beneficial relationships with donors and funding partners to support the University's goals in instruction, research, and community engagement.

Core Principles

Alignment with UM's Mission and Vision: All fundraising activities must directly support UM's mission, vision, strategic plans, and priorities. This includes advancing academic excellence, research innovation, and community development initiatives.

Ethical Conduct: UM is committed to the highest ethical standards in all fundraising activities. This includes:

- Truthfulness and accuracy in all representations to donors.
- Respect for donor privacy and confidentiality.
- Avoidance of high-pressure or coercive fundraising tactics.
- Transparency in the use of funds.
- Adherence to all applicable laws, regulations, and professional codes of conduct.
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Transparency and Accountability: UM will maintain transparent and accountable fundraising practices. This includes:

- Providing clear and accurate information to donors about how their contributions will be used.
- Maintaining proper records of all donations and funding received.
- Regularly reporting to donors and stakeholders on the use of funds and the impact of their contributions.
- Ensuring that funds are used efficiently and effectively to achieve their intended purpose.

Donor-Centric Approach: UM values its donors and funding partners and is committed to building strong, long-term relationships based on mutual respect, trust, and understanding. This includes:

- Understanding donors' interests and motivations.
- Providing donors with meaningful engagement opportunities.
- Recognizing and acknowledging donor contributions appropriately.
- Maintaining open and responsive communication with donors.

Sustainability: UM seeks to diversify its funding sources to ensure long-term financial stability and support the University's sustainable growth. This includes:

- Cultivating diverse funding streams, including individual giving, corporate partnerships, grants, and alumni support.

- Encouraging recurring donations and planned giving.
- Exploring opportunities for income-generating activities that align with UM's mission.

Compliance with Regulations: All fundraising activities will be conducted in compliance with relevant Philippine laws and regulations, including those related to charitable giving, tax exemptions, and data privacy.

Donations and Funding Strategies

UM will employ a range of strategies to achieve sustainable donations and funding, including but not limited to:

Alumni Engagement and Giving: Strengthening relationships with UM alumni and encouraging their financial support through annual giving, special campaigns, and alumni association initiatives.

Individual Giving: Cultivating relationships with individual donors, including faculty, staff, parents, and community members, through direct mail, online giving platforms, and major gift fundraising.

Corporate Partnerships: Developing strategic partnerships with corporations and businesses through sponsorships, corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives, and in-kind donations that align with UM's values and objectives.

Grants and Foundations: Seeking grants from local, national, and international foundations and government agencies to support specific programs, research projects, and capital improvements.

Special Events: Organizing fundraising events, such as galas, benefit concerts, and fun runs, to raise funds and engage the community.

Planned Giving: Encouraging donors to include UM in their estate plans through bequests, trusts, and other planned giving vehicles.

Endowment Building: Establishing and growing an endowment fund to provide a stable and long-term source of funding for the University.

Income Generation: Exploring opportunities for mission-aligned income-generating activities, such as continuing education programs, research commercialization, and university-owned enterprises.

Donor Relations and Stewardship

UM is committed to maintaining strong relationships with its donors through:

Gift Acknowledgment: Providing prompt and appropriate acknowledgment and official receipts for all donations.

Donor Recognition: Recognizing and honoring donors through various means, such as donor walls, publications, and special events, in accordance with their wishes.

Regular Communication: Keeping donors informed about UM's progress and the impact of their contributions through newsletters, reports, and other communication channels.

Engagement Opportunities: Providing opportunities for donors to engage with UM's programs and activities, such as campus visits, lectures, and special events.

Confidentiality: Protecting the privacy of donor information and adhering to donor preferences regarding anonymity and communication.

Gift Acceptance: Establishing guidelines for accepting donations, including gifts with restrictions, to ensure alignment with UM's mission and policies.

Governance and Oversight

The Alumni Affairs Office (AAO) will be responsible for the implementation and oversight of this policy.

The AAO and the Treasury Department will provide regular reports to the University President on fundraising activities, outcomes, and compliance with this policy.

This policy will be reviewed and updated periodically to ensure its effectiveness and alignment with UM's strategic goals and relevant regulations.

Policy Review and Amendments

This policy will be reviewed every three (3) years, or as needed, to ensure its continued relevance and effectiveness. Any amendments to this policy must be approved by the Board of Trustees.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President